

International Teacher Readiness Checklist

Are You Ready for an International Teaching Career?



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International school recruitment is becoming increasingly competitive. Schools are not only looking for qualified teachers but also for educators who demonstrate professionalism, adaptability, and a commitment to continuous learning. This checklist will help you evaluate your readiness before you begin applying.

Tick each statement that applies to you and make note of any areas where you need further preparation.

1. Qualifications

Your qualifications are the foundation of your application. Most international schools expect teachers to hold a recognized teaching qualification in addition to a relevant university degree. Recruiters will also expect your certificates and registration documents to be readily available.

Checklist

- ☐ I hold a recognized teaching qualification.
- ☐ My university degree certificates are available.
- ☐ My teaching license or registration is current.

Why this matters

Recruiters normally shortlist candidates who meet the minimum academic and professional requirements. Missing qualifications or incomplete documentation can delay or prevent your application from progressing.

If you answered "No"

Prepare certified copies of your qualifications and ensure your teaching registration is valid before applying.

2. Teaching Experience

Experience is important, but recruiters are interested in more than the number of years you have taught. They want evidence that you have helped students learn, improved outcomes, and contributed to school life.

Checklist

- ☐ I have at least one year of classroom teaching experience.
- ☐ I can demonstrate measurable student achievement.
- ☐ I have participated in extracurricular activities or school leadership.

Why this matters

Schools value teachers who contribute beyond the classroom. Clubs, sports, mentoring, trips, and leadership responsibilities all strengthen your application.

If you answered "No"

Volunteer for additional responsibilities in your current school to broaden your experience.

3. Application Documents

Your CV and supporting documents are often your first impression. A well-written application can determine whether you are shortlisted for an interview.

Checklist

- ☐ My CV is tailored for international schools.
- ☐ I have a professional cover letter template.
- ☐ My referees are ready to provide references.
- ☐ My LinkedIn profile is complete and up to date.

Why this matters

International recruiters often spend less than a minute reviewing an application. A professional CV that demonstrates measurable impact is far more likely to secure an interview.

If you answered "No"

Review your CV and LinkedIn profile before submitting any applications.

4. Recruitment Readiness

Many teachers struggle because they begin applying without understanding where to find opportunities or which schools match their experience.

Checklist

- ☐ I know which curriculum I am qualified to teach.
- ☐ I have identified the countries where I would like to work.
- ☐ I know where to find international teaching vacancies.
- ☐ My passport is valid.

Why this matters

Having a clear job search strategy saves time and helps you focus on opportunities that match your qualifications and career goals.

If you answered "No"

Research reputable recruitment platforms and begin identifying schools that fit your experience and interests.

5. Interview Preparation

Receiving an interview invitation is only the beginning. Successful candidates prepare carefully and communicate their teaching philosophy with confidence.

Checklist

- ☐ I can clearly explain my teaching philosophy.
- ☐ I understand safeguarding and child protection.
- ☐ I can provide examples of differentiation and assessment strategies.
- ☐ I have practiced answering common interview questions.

Why this matters

Recruiters want evidence that you can create engaging learning experiences while ensuring student wellbeing and maintaining high professional standards.

If you answered "No"

Practice answering interview questions aloud and prepare examples from your own teaching experience.

Your Readiness Score

Count the number of boxes you ticked.

- **16–18:** Excellent. You appear to be well prepared to begin applying for international teaching positions. Continue refining your CV and application strategy.
- **12–15:** Good progress. You have a strong foundation but should address the remaining gaps before applying widely.
- **Below 12:** Preparation recommended. Focus on strengthening your qualifications, documentation, and application materials before beginning your international job search.

Your Action Plan

Continue Your Journey

This checklist helps you assess your readiness, but it is only the first step. If you are serious about securing a teaching position in an international school, the **Global Educator's Job Search Handbook** provides a complete, step-by-step guide to:

- Finding international teaching opportunities.
- Writing an interview-winning CV.
- Preparing compelling applications.
- Succeeding in interviews.
- Understanding recruiter expectations.
- Developing a structured job search strategy.

With practical templates, examples, and expert guidance, it is designed to

help you move from preparation to successful employment in an international school. **Check your email for additional advice.**

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